DAILY BRIEF / KAMPALA

Today in the news

Sunday, 18 October 2026 · prepared 9:45 AM EAT

Window: the last 24 hours, from Saturday 17 October, 9:45 AM

Uganda's day was dominated by infrastructure and institutional news: the Katonga Bridge was commissioned at Shs191b, Isimba's unresolved spillway defects resurfaced as the rains approach, and four people were remanded over a Munyonyo land deal. Abroad, France had its most violent day of protest in months with more than 1,200 arrests, and Washington suspended Russia sanctions days before they were to bite.

UGANDA

Isimba dam defects renew flooding fears as the rains approach

Sat 17 Oct, about 8:45 PM · Monitor / Uganda Radio Network

Unresolved defects at the 183MW Isimba hydropower plant have revived concern that excess water could flood the dam as Uganda enters a season of heavier rainfall. Engineers say the spillway cannot safely handle its full design capacity, and that the contractor, China International Water and Electric Corporation, has done little to repair it. Officials led by Eng Badiru Kiggundu and managers from UEGCL revisited the plant on Friday.

Government commissions Shs191b Katonga Bridge, and demands it last 120 years

Sat 17 Oct, about 12:45 PM · Monitor / Busein Samilu

Works and Transport minister Fred Byamukama commissioned the bridge on Saturday and warned government engineers against substandard work, saying technical experts had assured him of its durability. The contractor, CCCC, was told to speed up the Nakawuka-Nateete road, and contractors nationwide were cautioned that prolonged roadworks raise fuel costs for motorists.

Three KCCA officials and a land dealer remanded over Shs600m Munyonyo land fraud

Sat 17 Oct, about 5:45 PM · Monitor

The four were produced in court over a land transaction in Munyonyo valued at Shs600m and remanded.

NETA Uganda opens dialogue with the central bank over interest rates and fuel costs

Sat 17 Oct, 7:28 PM · New Vision

The business grouping has asked Bank of Uganda for talks on rising interest rates and fuel costs, arguing both are squeezing operating margins.

Government gazettes Nyabongo I as Omukama of Tooro

Sat 17 Oct, about 2:45 PM · Monitor

The gazetting formalises the succession in the Tooro kingdom.

Charcoal ban row sharpens as Igara MP calls its supporters 'enemies of the people'

Sat 17 Oct, about 8:45 PM · Nile Post

The MP for Igara, Kyampene, attacked backers of the ban on charcoal, widening a dispute that pits conservation policy against household fuel costs.

Two arrested over the killing of a Gulu University student

Sat 17 Oct, about 4:45 PM · Monitor

Police have held two suspects in the death of the student, whose killing has drawn attention to safety around the campus.

A further Shs260b committed to AFCON 2027 preparation

Sun 18 Oct, about 7:45 AM · Monitor

The commitment adds to spending on stadium and tournament readiness ahead of the 2027 finals Uganda co-hosts.

Kitara FC lose 2-1 to Al Ahly in the CAF Confederation Cup first leg

Sat 17 Oct, 6:56 PM · New Vision

The result leaves Kitara needing to overturn a one-goal deficit in the return leg in Cairo.

WORLD

France: more than 1,200 arrested as cost-of-living protests turn violent

Sun 18 Oct, 8:56 AM · BBC News / Jack Burgess

Clashes, looting and arson spread across France on Saturday in the latest day of demonstrations over hardship in schools and the cost of living, with an estimated 550,000 people on the streets. Riot police used tear gas and water cannon in Paris, and a fire in Limoges town hall partly collapsed its roof. Prime Minister Sebastien Lecornu said 150 police officers were injured.

Trump blocks several Russia sanctions two days before they were due to take effect

Sun 18 Oct, 4:10 AM · BBC News / Max Matza

Trump signed an executive order on Friday night suspending sanctions that Congress had passed and he had signed into law in September, saying the move was in the national interest. Zelensky said Washington had chosen to 'completely disregard' them; Russia's envoy Kirill Dmitriev called the order historic. Secretary of State Marco Rubio said the pause was to analyse the effect on the global economy.

Deaths confirmed in a major fire at a Canadian military base

Sun 18 Oct, 7:00 AM · BBC News / Kelly Ng

Defence minister David McGuinty confirmed people had been killed and injured at Canadian Forces Base Wainwright in Alberta but gave no numbers, describing the situation as 'very, very active and delicate'. The base is Canada's principal site for live-fire training, and high winds caused the blaze to spread rapidly.

At least 17 dead in a crush at a Durga Puja event in Kolkata

Sat 17 Oct, 10:19 PM · BBC News / George Wright

Officials say 17 people were killed and 25 injured when sudden rain triggered a surge in the crowd. A seven-year-old girl was among the dead. West Bengal chief minister Suvendu Adhikari said the regional government was helping affected families.

Anti-government protesters battle police in Albania

Sat 17 Oct, 11:53 PM · BBC News

Demonstrators opposed to the government clashed with police in the latest night of unrest.

Pope discharged from hospital days after lung cancer surgery

Sat 17 Oct, 4:51 PM · BBC News

The Pope has left hospital and is returning to the Vatican to continue his recovery.

SOURCES AND METHOD

Monitor (monitor.co.ug) - Uganda news front page and article pages, read 18 Oct 2026 between 9:45 and 9:50 AM EAT.

New Vision (newvision.co.ug) - front-page article timestamps, read 18 Oct 2026.

Nile Post (nilepost.co.ug) - front page, read 18 Oct 2026.

BBC News world feed and article pages, read 18 Oct 2026.

Every item is dated by its own publication stamp, converted to Kampala time. Figures are as the source reported them.